

Nouns and verbs

Teaching guide

Choose the form that fits a sentence.

Understand the distinction

A noun can name a thing, action, or idea; a verb tells what happens or describes a state. Some words have the same spelling in both roles: a plan / we plan. Other families change form: a decision / decide.

Look at the sentence pattern. An article such as a often comes before a noun phrase. A subject often needs a verb. Endings can help, but they are not reliable rules for every word. Check an unfamiliar word in a dictionary.

Compare the patterns

NOUN

We made a decision.

Decision names the result.

VERB

We decided to wait.

Decided is the past-tense verb.

BOTH

We plan to discuss the plan.

The first plan is a verb; the second is a noun.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. We need to ___ today. (decision / decide)

A. decision

B. decisive

C. decide

2. Please make a ___ . (choice / choose)

A. choice

B. choosing

C. choose

3. Identify the verb: They work at a school.

A. They

B. school

C. work

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Which pair uses a verb and its related noun correctly?

- A. We discussion the problem. The discussion was useful.
- B. We discussed the problem. The discuss was useful.
- C. We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. decide

To is followed by the base verb in this pattern.

A: After need to, use the verb decide. Decision is a noun.

B: Decisive is an adjective. This position needs a verb.

2. A. choice

A introduces a noun phrase.

B: The usual expression for this meaning is make a choice.

C: Make a takes a noun here: choice. Choose is a verb.

3. C. work

Work tells what they do.

A: They is the subject pronoun; work is the verb.

B: School is a noun in the phrase at a school.

4. C. We discussed the problem. The discussion was useful.

Discussed is the past-tense verb; discussion is the noun.

A: The first sentence needs the verb discussed.

B: After the, this sentence needs the noun discussion.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-06.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Which pair uses a verb and its related noun correctly?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.